

Open-ended responses were coded separately by question using question-specific, multi-label codebooks. A response could receive more than one code, so percentages within a question do not necessarily sum to 100%. Two researchers independently coded a subset of responses and achieved substantial agreement (Cohen's $\kappa = 0.86$). Disagreements were resolved through discussion before coding the remaining responses.

Table 1: Codes for final strength judgment reasoning. $N = 1, 201$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Participant's own assessment	Password construction / complexity	537	44.7
	Predictability / commonness / guessability	399	33.2
	Prior knowledge / experience / personal criteria	187	15.6
PSM feedback as evidence	Direct PSM evidence	330	27.5
	Agreement / majority across PSMs	201	16.7
	Conflicting PSM evidence	37	3.1

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 2: Codes for final action reasoning. $N = 1, 201$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Assessment of what should be done	Password adequacy / inadequacy	720	60.0
	Repairability / strengthening	307	25.6
	Replace / start over	122	10.2
	Security / precaution	217	18.1
	Usability / effort	146	12.2
PSM feedback as an action cue	Direct PSM action cue	235	19.6
	Agreement / disagreement as action cue	73	6.1

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 3: Codes for judgment trajectory reasoning. $N = 1, 189$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Processing of sequential PSM feedback	Direct feedback-driven updating	355	29.9
	Accumulation / repeated evidence	311	26.2
	Conflict / switch-driven re-evaluation	58	4.9
	Explicit sequence / progression	283	23.8
Relationship to prior judgment	Confirmation / reinforcement	113	9.5
	Reconsideration / second-guessing	91	7.7
	Resistance / stability	316	26.6
Independent password/self anchor	Independent password / self anchor	542	45.6

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 4: Codes for self-versus-PSM decision reasoning. $N = 835$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Reasons for relying on oneself	Knowledge / experience / intuition	414	49.6
	Password-specific criteria	296	35.4
Reasons for relying on PSM feedback	Direct PSM deference	30	3.6
	PSM expertise / technical authority	57	6.8
	Cross-PSM corroboration	106	12.7
Conditional evaluation of self vs. PSM	Explicit balancing / relative weighting	40	4.8
	Plausibility / fit	24	2.9
	PSM skepticism / opacity / differing standards	47	5.6

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 5: Codes for reasoning about resolving conflict across PSMs. $N = 698$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Using PSM ratings to resolve conflict	Majority / count rule	96	13.8
	Outlier dismissal	10	1.4
	Averaging / integration	29	4.2
	Sequence / recency	32	4.6
	Direct / selective PSM reliance	100	14.3
Using independent judgment as a tiebreaker	Own judgment / intuition	222	31.8
	Knowledge / experience	122	17.5
	Password-feature tiebreaker	197	28.2
	Safety-first rule	24	3.4
Evaluating PSM source credibility	Source credibility / standards	46	6.6

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 6: Codes for reasoning about repeated same-direction PSM ratings. $N = 499$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Repetition strengthened the evidence	Corroboration / consistency	198	39.7
	Cumulative persuasion	90	18.0
Repetition changed relation to prior view	Confirmation	63	12.6
	Increased certainty / confidence	66	13.2
	Reconsideration / second-guessing	39	7.8
Repetition added little / created resistance	No additional effect	67	13.4
	Redundancy / diminishing value	3	0.6
Repetition triggered skepticism	Skepticism triggered by repetition	17	3.4

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

Table 7: Codes for trust reasoning. $N = 1,201$.

Category	Code	<i>n</i>	%
Cross-PSM evidence pattern	Agreement / corroboration	404	33.6
	Conflict / inconsistency	157	13.1
Calibration against own assessment	Agreement / plausibility	83	6.9
	Mismatch / implausibility	25	2.1
	Own/password-based calibration	484	40.3
PSM/source qualities	Standards / methods / criteria	127	10.6
	Transparency / explanation	41	3.4
	Authority / capability / credibility	158	13.2
	Prior experience / baseline trust	71	5.9

Percentages use the number of responses to the corresponding question as the denominator.

The codes summarize reported reasoning and are not intended to identify mutually exclusive participant types or psychological mechanisms.